

Development Phases and Roadmap

Step-by-step delivery plan with milestones and acceptance checks

Project	Course Enrollment Platform (courses: Digital Marketing, SEO, Content Writing, Web Development)
Version	1.0 (Draft for developer review)
Audience	Development team, project owner, and QA

The project is delivered in seven phases. Each phase ends with a demo on the staging site and a written sign-off from the owner before the next phase begins. Durations assume one full-time developer plus part-time design and QA; the developer should confirm or adjust them.

1. Timeline at a Glance

Phase	Name	Duration	Milestone
1	Discovery and Planning	1 week	Approved scope, content checklist, tech stack decision
2	UI/UX Design	2 weeks	Approved mockups for all key pages
3	Frontend Development	3 weeks	Responsive public site with static content
4	Backend and Core Features	4 weeks	Accounts, courses, batches, enrollment flow working
5	Payments and Admin Panel	3 weeks	Payments, receipts, admin tools, notifications, certificates
6	Testing, SEO, and Security	2 weeks	Bug-free release candidate on staging
7	Launch and Handover	1 week	Live site, training, documentation, 30-day support begins

Estimated total: about 16 weeks (4 months). Some work overlaps (for example design refinement during frontend work), which can shorten the schedule.

Phase 1 - Discovery and Planning (Week 1)

Goal: Confirm exactly what is being built and prepare everything the team needs.

Key tasks

- Review the PRD, Architecture, Rules, and Design documents; resolve open questions
- Decide the final tech stack (custom or WordPress) and hosting; set up domain and email
- Create the repository, project board, environments, and CI pipeline
- Owner prepares the content checklist: course details, fees, batches, instructor bios, logo, brand colors, policy text
- Collect payment-gateway requirements and start merchant account applications

Deliverable	Approval gate
Signed-off scope document, project plan, repository and staging environment ready	Owner approves scope and stack in writing

Phase 2 - UI/UX Design (Weeks 2-3)

Goal: Turn the Design document into approved visual mockups.

Key tasks

- Wireframes for Home, Courses, Course Detail, Enrollment, Login/Register, Student Dashboard, Admin Dashboard, Contact
- High-fidelity mobile and desktop mockups using the brand style
- Reusable component library (buttons, cards, forms, tables, modals)
- Clickable prototype of the enrollment flow
- One round of owner feedback and one round of revisions

Deliverable	Approval gate
Design files and component library, approved by the owner	Owner signs off on mockups; no page is built before approval

Phase 3 - Frontend Development (Weeks 4-6)

Goal: Build all public pages and the shared layout.

Key tasks

- Global layout: header, footer, navigation, sticky Enroll button, floating WhatsApp button
- Home, Courses list with search and filters, Course Detail, About, Instructors, Contact, FAQ, legal pages
- Responsive behavior from 360px to large desktop
- Basic SEO: meta tags, headings, Open Graph, sitemap and robots setup
- Image optimization and lazy loading

Deliverable	Approval gate
Fully styled public site running on staging with placeholder or real content	Pages match mockups; PageSpeed mobile 85+ at this stage

Phase 4 - Backend and Core Features (Weeks 7-10)

Goal: Make the site dynamic and let students enroll.

Key tasks

- Database schema and migrations; seed data for the four courses
- Auth: register, login, email verification, password reset, roles
- Course, module, instructor, batch, and FAQ APIs connected to the frontend
- Enrollment flow with seat checks and 48-hour holds
- Student dashboard: my courses, status, profile, batch schedule
- Contact form with email notification and spam protection

Deliverable	Approval gate
Student can register, view courses, and submit an enrollment on staging	End-to-end test of register to pending enrollment passes

Phase 5 - Payments and Admin Panel (Weeks 11-13)

Goal: Complete money handling and give the owner full control.

Key tasks

- Manual payment: receipt upload, admin approve or reject, status changes, emails
- Gateway integration (JazzCash, Easypaisa, or card) with signed webhooks, once the merchant account is ready
- Receipt or invoice PDF generation
- Admin panel: dashboard stats, CRUD for courses, batches, instructors, FAQs, testimonials, blog; student and enrollment management; CSV export
- Role-based access for Super Admin, Admin/Staff, Instructor
- Certificate generation with public verification page; reviews with moderation
- Email templates: verification, enrollment received, payment confirmed, batch reminder

Deliverable	Approval gate
Complete working system on staging, including admin control	Owner completes a full test: add course, add batch, enroll a test student, approve payment, issue certificate

Phase 6 - Testing, SEO, and Security (Weeks 14-15)

Goal: Find and fix problems before real students arrive.

Key tasks

- Functional, cross-browser, and device testing; bug fixing
- Security review: access control, upload limits, rate limits, injection and XSS checks, dependency audit
- Performance tuning: caching, CDN, image sizes; target PageSpeed 90+ on mobile
- SEO finishing: schema markup, sitemap, redirects, Search Console and Analytics setup
- Backup and restore test; error monitoring and uptime alerts configured
- User acceptance testing by the owner and staff

Deliverable	Approval gate
Release candidate with a test report and list of resolved issues	No open critical or high-priority bugs

Phase 7 - Launch and Handover (Week 16)

Goal: Go live smoothly and make sure the owner can run everything.

Key tasks

- Production deployment, SSL, DNS, final smoke test
- Load real course content, fees, and batches
- Admin training session and a short written or video guide
- Handover of source code, credentials, documentation, and API docs
- 30 days of free bug-fix support starts; post-launch review at day 30

Deliverable	Approval gate
Live website and complete handover package	Owner confirms the acceptance criteria in the PRD are met

2. Owner Responsibilities per Phase

Phase	What the owner provides or decides
1	Institute name, logo, brand colors, domain, preferred stack decision, list of courses and fees
2	Feedback on mockups within 3 working days; approval in writing
3	Course descriptions, curriculum, instructor bios and photos, testimonials
4	Batch schedules and seat capacities; email address for notifications
5	Payment account details (bank, JazzCash, Easypaisa, or gateway credentials); refund policy text
6	Time to test as an admin and as a student; staff availability for testing
7	Final content approval; go-live decision; staff for training

3. Post-Launch Backlog (Version 2 Ideas)

- Recorded video lessons, quizzes, and assignments (full LMS)
- Live class integration with Zoom or Google Meet links per batch
- Urdu and English language switch
- Coupons, referral codes, and installment plans
- Student attendance tracking and progress reports
- WhatsApp or SMS reminders
- Native mobile app

4. Project Risks and Controls

Risk	Impact	Control
Content arrives late	Delays Phases 3-4	Use placeholders; keep a shared content tracker
Gateway approval delayed	Online payments not ready at launch	Launch with bank transfer; add gateway as an update
Scope creep	Budget and timeline overruns	Freeze V1 scope; new ideas go to the V2 backlog
Developer availability	Missed milestones	Weekly updates; milestone-based payments
Security incident after launch	Data loss or trust damage	Phase 6 security review, backups, monitoring

5. Suggested Payment Milestones for the Developer

Milestone	Share of project fee
Project start (after Phase 1 sign-off)	20%
Design approval (end of Phase 2)	15%
Frontend complete (end of Phase 3)	20%
Core features complete (end of Phase 4)	20%
Payments and admin complete (end of Phase 5)	15%
Launch and handover (end of Phase 7)	10%

These shares are a suggestion; the owner and developer can agree different ones in writing.